

How to use these token cutouts



These pages contain the text *Australia* by Simple English Wikipedia contributors. Each **cutout** shows a **next word** paired with the **previous word** that came immediately before it in the original text.

Model vitals	
5037 tokens	3.18 bits/token entropy
9 perplexity	2.91 branching factor

Anatomy of a cutout



Every distinct word has its own colour. **Previous** words appear inside a coloured box (the word's own colour as the background, with white text); the free-standing **next word** appears in plain coloured text. The same word always wears the same colour, whether you see it inside a box or free-standing. Two unrelated words can occasionally share a colour, so always verify the word itself matches—not just the colour.

Setup

Cut out the tokens along the dotted lines and **spread them out** face-up on the table, with no overlap if possible. This is the “training” step: every (previous, next) combination from the original text is now a physical cutout sitting on your table.

How to play: the matching game

To generate text, repeatedly find a cutout whose **previous word** matches the last word you've written, then **write its next word** onto your page. The word you just wrote becomes part of what you'll match against next—that's the chain.

Worked example

Step 1. Pick any cutout to begin—say this one—and copy its previous word *and* its next word onto your page.

Step 2. Look at the last word you’ve written (*the*) and find a cutout whose previous word matches it. Write its next word.

Step 3. Repeat: find a cutout whose previous word matches the last word you’ve written, and add its next word.

Keep going—write as much or as little as you like.

the cutout

officially the

the Commonwealth

Commonwealth of

your page

officially the

officially the **Commonwealth**

officially the Commonwealth **of**

Tips

Use colour as a fast filter. Scan by the rightmost previous-word box’s colour first, then verify the actual word matches.

Pick from many candidates by eye. The more cutouts share the same previous word, the more often your eye lands on one—that’s **weighted sampling** for free, and it’s why some words follow others more often in your text.

Put the cutout back after using it—removing it would change the model’s distribution next time round.

Australia **Australia** , **,** officially **officially** the
the Commonwealth **Commonwealth** of
of Australia **Australia** , **,** is **is** an **an** island
island country **country** and **and** sovereign
sovereign state **state** located **located** in **in** the
the southern **southern** hemisphere **hemisphere** ,
, in **in** Oceania **Oceania** . **.** its **its** capital
capital city **city** is **is** Canberra **Canberra** ,
, and **and** its **its** largest **largest** city **city** is
is Sydney **Sydney** . **.** it **it** is **is** mostly **mostly** a

a desert **desert** country **country** . **Australia**

Australia is **is** the **the** sixth **sixth** biggest

biggest country **country** in **in** the **the** world

world by **by** land **land** area **area** , **,** and **and** is

is part **part** of **of** the **the** Oceanic **Oceanic** and

and Australasian **Australasian** regions **regions** .

Australia **Australia** , **,** new **new** Zealand

Zealand , **,** new **new** Guinea **Guinea** and

and other **other** islands **islands** on **on** the

the Australian **Australian** tectonic **tectonic** plate

plate are are together together called
called Australasia Australasia , , which
which is is one one of of the the world's
world's great great ecozones ecozones . . when
when other other Pacific Pacific islands
islands are are included included with
with Australasia Australasia , , it it is is called
called Oceania Oceania . 27 . million
million people people live live in in Australia
Australia , , and and about 85 about of

of them them live live near near the the east

east coast coast . the the country country is

is divided divided up up into into six six states

states and and two two territories territories ,

, and and more more than than half half of

of Australia's Australia's population

population lives lives in in and and around

around the the cities cities of of Sydney

Sydney , , Melbourne Melbourne , , Brisbane

Brisbane , , Perth Perth and and Adelaide

Adelaide . the the first first people people to
to live live in in the the country country were
were the the Indigenous Indigenous Australians
Australians : : many many of of them
them died died from from smallpox
smallpox during during colonisation
colonisation . . Australia Australia is is known
known for for its its mining mining coal
coal , , iron iron , , gold gold , , diamonds
diamonds and and crystals crystals . . it

it produces produces wool wool , , and and is

is the the world's world's largest

largest producer producer of of bauxite

bauxite . . its its emblem emblem is is a

a flower flower called called the the golden

golden wattle wattle . . Australia Australia is

is also also known known for for its

its animals animals . . the the national

national symbols symbols of of Australia

Australia are are the the kangaroo

kangaroo and and the the golden

golden wattle wattle . Scientifically

Scientifically , , perhaps perhaps even

even more more important important are

are its its two two monotreme

monotreme mammals mammals : : the

the platypus platypus and and the the echidna

echidna . . Geography Geography Australia's

Australia's landmass landmass of 7 of , 617 ,

930 , square square kilometres 2 kilometres ,

941 , 300 sq sq mi mi is is on on the

the Indo Indo Australian Australian plate

plate . the the continent continent of

of Australia Australia , , including

including the the island island of of Tasmania

Tasmania , , was was separated separated from

from the the other other continents

continents of of the the world world many

many millions millions of of years years ago

ago . because because of of this this , , many

many animals **animals** and **and** plants

plants live **live** in **in** Australia **Australia** that

that do **do** not **not** live **live** anywhere

anywhere else **else** . **.** these **these** include

include animals **animals** like **like** the

the kangaroo **kangaroo** , **,** the **the** koala

koala , **,** the **the** emu **emu** , **,** the

the kookaburra **kookaburra** , **,** the **the** wallaby

wallaby and **and** the **the** wombat **wombat** .

. the **the** duck **duck** billed **billed** platypus

platypus and and the the echidna echidna are
are completely completely unique unique .
. people people first first arrived arrived in
in Australia Australia more more than 50
than , 000 , years years ago ago . . these
these native native Australians Australians are
are called called Aboriginal
Aboriginal Australians Australians and
and Torres Torres Strait Strait Islanders
Islanders . . for for the the history history of

of Australia Australia , , see see history

history of of Australia Australia . . most

most of of the the Australian

Australian colonies colonies , , having

having been been settled settled from

from Britain Britain , , became became mostly

mostly independent independent democratic

democratic states states in in the 1850s

the and and all all six six combined

combined as as a a federation federation on 1

on January 1901 January . the the first
first Prime Prime Minister Minister of
of Australia Australia was was Edmund
Edmund Barton Barton in 1901 in . Australia
Australia is is a a member member of of the
the United United Nations Nations and and the
the Commonwealth Commonwealth of
of Nations Nations . it it is is a
a parliamentary parliamentary democracy
democracy and and a a constitutional

constitutional monarchy monarchy with

with King King Charles III Charles as as King

King of of Australia Australia and and head

head of of state state and and a a governor

governor General General who who is

is chosen chosen by by the the Prime

Prime Minister Minister to to carry carry out

out all all the the duties duties of of the

the King King in in Australia Australia .

. regions regions and and cities cities Australia

Australia has has six six states states , , two
two major major mainland mainland territories
territories , , and and other other offshore
offshore minor minor territories territories .
. the the states states are are new new south
south Wales Wales , , Queensland
Queensland , , south south Australia
Australia , , Victoria Victoria , , western
western Australia Australia and and Tasmania
Tasmania which which is is a a large

large island island located located south

south of of the the east east coast coast .

. the the two two major major mainland

mainland territories territories are are the

the Northern Northern territory territory and

and the the Australian Australian capital

capital territory territory ACT ACT . the

the population population is is about 27

about million million people 2021

people census 25 census , 890 , 773 , .

. most **most** Australians **Australians** live **live** in
in cities **cities** along **along** the **the** coast
coast , **,** such **such** as **as** Sydney **Sydney** ,
, Melbourne **Melbourne** , **,** Brisbane **Brisbane** ,
, Perth **Perth** , **,** Adelaide **Adelaide** ,
, Newcastle **Newcastle** and **and** the **the** gold
gold coast **coast** . **.** the **the** largest
largest inland **inland** city **city** is **is** Canberra
Canberra , **,** which **which** is **is** also **also** the
the nation's **nation's** capital **capital** . **.** the

the largest largest city city is is Sydney

Sydney but but by by some some measures

measures also also Melbourne Melbourne .

. Australia Australia is is a a large

large country country by by landmass

landmass , , but but much much of of the

the land land is is very very dry dry climate

climate , , and and the the middle middle of

of the the continent continent is is mostly

mostly a a hot hot desert desert . . only

only the the areas areas around around the
the east east , , west west and and south
south coast coast have have enough
enough rain rain and and a a suitable
suitable climate climate not not too too hot
hot and and dry dry for for farms farms and
and cities cities . . the the island island state
state of of Tasmania Tasmania has has a
a more more balanced balanced climate
climate than than much much of of the

the mainland mainland . climate

climate change change all all the the capital

capital cities cities except except Perth

Perth and and Darwin Darwin are are in

in the the south south east east of of the

the country country . there there is is now

now increasing increasing rainfall rainfall and

and flooding flooding which which affects

affects this this region region . it it is

is thought thought this this is is caused

caused by by climate climate change change ,
, and and may may continue continue to
to get get worse worse . the the BBC
BBC report report comments comments : : in
in the the past past three three years years ,
, record record breaking breaking bushfire
bushfire and and flood flood events
events have have killed killed more more than
500 than people people and and billions
billions of of animals animals . Drought

Drought , cyclones cyclones and and tides
tides have have gripped gripped communities
communities . the the BBC BBC report
report continues continues : : nowhere
nowhere is is this this a a bigger bigger issue
issue than than in in Queensland Queensland .
. it it is is home home to to almost 40
almost of of the 500 the , 000 , homes
homes projected projected to to be
be effectively effectively uninsurable

uninsurable . this this means means people

people can't can't get get insurance

insurance because because the the risk risk of

of flooding flooding in in one one season

season or or fire fire in in another

another season season is is too too great

great . history history Aboriginal

Aboriginal and and Torres Torres Strait

Strait Islander Islander people people the

the Aboriginal Aboriginal and and Torres

Torres Strait Strait Islander Islander people

people arrived arrived in in Australia

Australia about 60 about , 000 , years

years ago ago or or maybe maybe even

even earlier earlier . . until until the

the arrival arrival of of British British settlers

settlers in 1788 in , , the the Aboriginal

Aboriginal and and Torres Torres Strait

Strait Islander Islander people people lived

lived by by hunting hunting and and gathering

gathering food **food** from **from** the **the** land

land . **they** **they** lived **lived** in **in** all **all** sorts

sorts of **of** climates **climates** and **and** managed

managed the **the** land **land** in **in** different

different ways **ways** . **an** **an** example

example of **of** Aboriginal **Aboriginal** land

land management **management** was **was** the

the Cumberland **Cumberland** plain **plain** where

where Sydney **Sydney** is **is** now **now** . **every**

every few **few** years **years** , **the**

the Aboriginal **Aboriginal** and **and** Torres

Torres Strait Strait Islander **Islander** people

people would **would** burn **burn** the **the** grass

grass and **and** small **small** trees **trees** . **.** this

this meant **meant** that **that** a **a** lot **lot** of

of grass **grass** grew **grew** back **back** , **,** but

but not **not** many **many** big **big** trees **trees** .

. kangaroos **kangaroos** and **and** wallabies

wallabies like **like** to **to** live **live** on **on** grassy

grassy plains **plains** , **,** but **but** not **not** in

in forests forests . the the kangaroos
kangaroos and and wallabies wallabies that
that lived lived on on the the plain plain were
were a a good good food food supply
supply for for the the Aboriginal
Aboriginal and and Torres Torres Strait
Strait Islander Islander people people .
. Sometimes Sometimes , , Aboriginals
Aboriginals and and Torres Torres Strait
Strait Islanders Islanders would would name

name a a person person after after an
an animal animal , , and and they they could
could not not eat eat that that animal
animal to to help help level level out out the
the food food population population .

. Aboriginal Aboriginal and and Torres
Torres Strait Strait Islander Islander people
people did did not not usually usually build
build structures structures , , except
except huts huts of of grass grass , , leaves

leaves and and bark bark . they they did

did not not usually usually build build walls

walls or or fences fences either either due

due to to their their hunter hunter gatherer

gatherer lifestyle lifestyle . of of the

the limited limited Aboriginal Aboriginal or

or Torres Torres Strait Strait Islander

Islander buildings buildings that that are

are known known the the most most common

common are are fish fish traps traps .

. however however , the the remains

remains of of a a few few stone stone huts

huts have have been been located located in

in Victoria Victoria and and Tasmania

Tasmania . the the Aboriginal Aboriginal and

and Torres Torres Strait Strait Islander

Islander people people did did not not use

use metal metal , , make make pottery

pottery or or use use bows bows and

and arrows arrows or or weave weave cloth

cloth . in in some some parts parts of

of Australia Australia the the people

people used used sharp sharp flaked

flaked stone stone spearheads spearheads ,

, but but most most Aboriginal Aboriginal and

and Torres Torres Strait Strait Islander

Islander spears spears were were made

made of of sharply sharply pointed

pointed wood wood , , some some being

being extremely extremely long long .

. Australia **Australia** has **has** a **a** lot **lot** of
of trees **trees** such **such** as **as** Eucalyptus
Eucalyptus , **,** that **that** have **have** very
very hard **hard** wood **wood** that **that** was
was good **good** for **for** spear **spear** making
making . **.** the **the** boomerang **boomerang** was
was used **used** in **in** some **some** areas **areas** for
for sport **sport** and **and** for **for** hunting
hunting . **.** the **the** first **first** Nations
Nations and **and** Torres **Torres** Strait

Strait Islanders

Islanders ,

as

as

a

a generalisation

generalisation ,

people

people did

did not

not think

think that

that the

the land

land belonged

belonged to

to them

them and

and they

they were

were instead

instead caretakers

caretakers .

. they

they believed

believed that

that they

they had

had grown

grown from

from the

the land

land ,

so

so it

it was

was like

like their

their mother

mother ,

and

and they they belonged belonged to to the
the land land however however this this varies
varies depending depending on on the
the Dreamtime Dreamtime lore lore that
that exists exists in in each each area area or
or community community . . Terra
Terra Australis Australis in in the 1600s the ,
, Dutch Dutch merchants merchants traded
traded with with the the islands islands of
of Batavia Batavia now now Indonesia

Indonesia , to to the the north north of
of Australia Australia and and several
several different different Dutch Dutch ships
ships touched touched on on the the coast
coast of of Australia Australia . the
the Dutch Dutch governor governor , , van
van Diemen Diemen , , sent sent Abel
Abel Tasman Tasman on on a a voyage
voyage of of discovery discovery and and he
he found found Tasmania Tasmania , , which

which he he named named van van Diemen's

Diemen's land land . its its name name was

was later later changed changed to to honour

honour the the man man who who discovered

discovered it it . the the British

British government government was was sure

sure that that there there must must be be a

a very very large large land land in in the

the south south , that that had had not

not been been explored explored . they

they sent sent Captain Captain James

James Cook Cook to to the the Pacific

Pacific Ocean Ocean . his his ship ship ,

, HMS HMS Endeavour Endeavour , , carried

carried the the famous famous scientists

scientists , , Sir Sir Joseph Joseph Banks

Banks and and Dr Dr Solander Solander who

who were were going going to to Tahiti

Tahiti where where they they would

would watch watch the the planet

planet Venus Venus pass pass in in front

front of of the the Sun Sun . . Captain

Captain Cook's Cook's secret secret mission

mission was was to to find find Terra

Terra Australis Australis the the land land of

of the the south south . . the the voyage

voyage of of discovery discovery was was very

very successful successful , , because

because they they found found new

new Zealand Zealand and and sailed

sailed right right around around it it . . then

then they they sailed sailed westward

westward . . at at last last , , a a boy boy ,

, William William Hicks Hicks , , who

who was was up up the the mast mast spotted

spotted land land on on the the horizon

horizon . . Captain Captain Cook Cook named

named that that bit bit of of land land Point

Point Hicks Hicks . . they they sailed

sailed up up the the coast coast and

and Captain Captain Cook Cook named

named the the land land that that he he saw

saw new new south south Wales Wales . . at

at last last they they sailed sailed into into a

a large large open open bay bay which

which was was full full of of fish fish and

and stingrays stingrays which which the

the sailors sailors speared speared for for food

food . . Joseph Joseph Banks Banks and

and Dr Dr . . Solander Solander went

went ashore ashore and and were

were astonished astonished to to find find that

that they they did did not not know

know what what any any of of the the plants

plants or or birds birds or or animals

animals that that they they saw saw were

were . . they they collected collected hundreds

hundreds of of plants plants to to take

take back back to to England England .

. Captain Captain Cook Cook saw saw the

the Aboriginal Aboriginal people people with
with their their simple simple way way of
of life life . he he saw saw them
them fishing fishing , , hunting hunting along
along with with collecting collecting grass
grass seeds seeds and and fruit fruit . but
but there there were were no no houses
houses and and no no fences fences . in
in most most parts parts of of the the world
world , , people people put put up up a

a house house and and a a fence fence or

or some some marker marker to to show

show that that they they own own the

the land land . but but the the Aboriginal

Aboriginal people people did did not not own

own the the mainland mainland in in that

that way way . they they belonged

belonged to to the the land land , like like a

a baby baby belongs belongs to to its

its mother mother . Captain Captain Cook

Cook went went home home to to England

England and and told told the the government

government that that no no one one owned

owned the the land land . . this this would

would later later cause cause a a terrible

terrible problem problem for for the

the Aboriginal Aboriginal people people .

. settlement settlement in in the 1700s the ,

, in in England England , , laws laws were

were tough tough , , many many people

people were **were** poor **poor** and **and** gaols

gaols jails **jails** were **were** full **full** . **.** a

a person **person** could **could** be **be** sentenced

sentenced to **to** death **death** for **for** stealing

stealing a **a** loaf **loaf** of **of** bread **bread** .

. many **many** people **people** were **were** hanged

hanged for **for** small **small** crimes **crimes** .

. but **but** usually **usually** they **they** were

were just **just** thrown **thrown** in **in** gaol **gaol** .

. often **often** they **they** were **were** sent

sent away away to to the the British

British colonies colonies in in America

America . but but by by the 1770s the ,

, the the colonies colonies in in America

America became became the the United

United states states . they they were

were free free from from British British rule

rule and and would would not not take

take England's England's convicts convicts any

any more more , , so so England

England needed needed to to find find a

a new new and and less less populated

populated place place . by by the 1780s

the the the gaols gaols of of England

England were were so so full full that

that convicts convicts were were often

often chained chained up up in in rotting

rotting old old ships ships . the

the government government decided decided to

to make make a a settlement settlement in

in new **new** south **south** Wales **Wales** and

and send **send** some **some** of **of** the

the convicts **convicts** there **there** . **.** in 1788

in the **the** first **first** Fleet **Fleet** of **of** eleven

eleven ships **ships** set **set** sail **sail** from

from Portsmouth **Portsmouth** carrying

carrying convicts **convicts** , **,** sailors **sailors** ,

, marines **marines** , **,** a **a** few **few** free

free settlers **settlers** and **and** enough

enough food **food** to **to** last **last** for **for** two

two years **years** . **.** their **their** leader

leader was **was** Captain **Captain** Arthur

Arthur Phillip **Phillip** . **.** they **they** were

were to **to** make **make** a **a** new **new** colony

colony at **at** the **the** place **place** that

that Captain **Captain** Cook **Cook** had

had discovered **discovered** , **,** named

named Botany **Botany** bay **bay** because

because of **of** all **all** the **the** unknown

unknown plants **plants** found **found** there

there by by the the two two scientists

scientists . . Captain Captain Phillip

Phillip found found that that Botany

Botany bay bay was was flat flat and

and windy windy . . there there was was not

not much much fresh fresh water water . . he

he went went with with two two ships

ships up up the the coast coast and and sailed

sailed into into a a great great harbour

harbour called called Port Port Jackson

Jackson , which which he he said said was
was the the finest finest harbour harbour in
in the the world world . there there were
were many many small small bays bays on
on the the harbour harbour so so he
he decided decided on on one one which
which had had a a good good stream
stream of of fresh fresh water water and
and some some flat flat shore shore to to land
land on on . on 26 on January 1788

January , the the flag flag was was raised
raised and and new new south south Wales
Wales was was claimed claimed in in the
the name name of of King King George III
George of of England England , and and the
the new new settlement settlement was
was called called Sydney Sydney . for for the
the first first few few years years of of the
the settlement settlement , things things were
were very very difficult difficult . no no one

one in in the the British British government

government had had thought thought very

very hard hard about about what what sort

sort of of convicts convicts should should be

be sent sent to to make make a a new

new colony colony . . Nobody Nobody had

had chosen chosen them them carefully

carefully . . there there was was only

only one one man man who who was was a

a farmer farmer . . there there was was no

no one **one** among **among** the **the** convicts

convicts **who** **who** was **was** a **a** builder

builder , **,** a **a** brick **brick** **maker** **maker** or

or a **a** blacksmith **blacksmith** . **.** no **no** one

one knew **knew** how **how** to **to** fix **fix** the

the tools **tools** when **when** they **they** broke

broke . **.** all **all** of **of** the **the** cattle

cattle escaped **escaped** . **.** there **there** were

were no **no** cooking **cooking** pots **pots** . **.** all

all the **the** plants **plants** were **were** different

different so so no no one one knew

knew which which ones ones could could be

be eaten eaten . . it it was was probable

probable that that everyone everyone in in the

the new new colony colony would would die

die of of starvation starvation . . the the little

little group group of of tents tents had had a

a hut hut for for the the governor governor ,

, Arthur Arthur Phillip Phillip , , and

and another another hut hut for for the

the supply supply of of food food . . soon

soon it it grew grew into into a a small

small town town with with streets streets , , a

a bridge bridge over over the the stream

stream , , a a windmill windmill for

for grinding grinding grain grain and

and wharves wharves for for ships ships . . by

by the 1820s the there there was was a a fine

fine brick brick house house for for the

the governor governor . . there there was

was also also a a hospital hospital and and a
a convict convict barracks barracks and and a
a beautiful beautiful church church which
which are are still still standing standing today
today . . Settlements Settlements had
had spread spread out out from from Sydney
Sydney , , firstly firstly to to Norfolk
Norfolk island island and and to to van
van Diemen's Diemen's land land Tasmania
Tasmania , , and and also also up up the

the coast coast to to Newcastle Newcastle ,
, where where coal coal was was discovered
discovered , , and and inland inland where
where the the missing missing cattle
cattle were were found found to to have
have grown grown to to a a large large herd
herd . . Spanish Spanish Merino Merino sheep
sheep had had been been brought brought to
to Sydney Sydney , , and and by 1820 by ,
, farmers farmers were were raising raising fat

fat lambs lambs for for meat meat and
and also also sending sending fine fine wool
wool back back to to the the factories
factories of of England England . while
while the the settlement settlement was
was growing growing in in new new south
south Wales Wales , , it it was was also
also growing growing in in Tasmania
Tasmania . the the climate climate in
in Tasmania Tasmania was was more more like

like that that in in England England , , and
and farmers farmers found found it it easy
easy to to grow grow crops crops there there .

• Exploration Exploration because

because Australia Australia is is such such a
a large large land land , , it it was was easy

easy in in the the minds minds of of early

early colonists colonists to to think think that

that it it might might be be able able to

to hold hold a a large large number

number of of people people . in in the
the early early days days of of the the colony
colony , , a a great great number number of
of explorers explorers went went out out ,
, searching searching for for fertile fertile and
and flat flat land land to to settle settle on
on . . when when the the settlers
settlers looked looked west west from
from Sydney Sydney , , they they saw saw a
a range range of of mountains

mountains which which they they called

called the the Blue Blue mountains

mountains . . they they were were not

not very very high high and and did did not

not look look very very rugged rugged but

but for for many many years years no no one

one could could find find their their way

way through through them them . . while

while not not high high in in elevation

elevation the the cliffs cliffs are are imposing

imposing and and numerous numerous and
and the the area area had had little little in
in the the way way of of traditionally
traditionally easy easy to to access
access resources resources . . in 1813 in ,
, Gregory Gregory Blaxland Blaxland ,
, William William Lawson Lawson and and a
17 a year year old old called called William
William Charles Charles Wentworth
Wentworth crossed crossed the the Blue

Blue mountains **mountains** and **and** found

found land **land** on **on** the **the** other

other side **side** which **which** was **was** good

good for **for** farming **farming** . **.** a **a** road

road was **was** built **built** and **and** the

the governor **governor** , **,** Lachlan

Lachlan Macquarie **Macquarie** founded

founded the **the** town **town** of **of** Bathurst

Bathurst on **on** the **the** other **other** side **side** ,

160 **,** km 100 **km** miles **miles** from

from Sydney Sydney . Bathurst

Bathurst became became Australia's

Australia's first first inland inland settlement

settlement . some some people people , like

like Captain Captain Charles Charles Sturt

Sturt were were sure sure that that there

there must must be be a a sea sea in in the

the middle middle of of Australia Australia and

and set set out out to to find find it it .

. many many of of the the explorers

explorers did did not not prepare prepare very
very well well , , or or else else they
they went went out out to to explore
explore at at the the hottest hottest time
time of of year year . . some some died
died like like Burke Burke and and Wills
Wills . . Ludwig Ludwig Leichhardt
Leichhardt got got lost lost twice twice . . the
the second second time time , , he he was
was never never seen seen again again .

. major **major** Thomas **Thomas** Mitchell

Mitchell was **was** one **one** of **of** the **the** most

most successful **successful** explorers **explorers** .

. he **he** mapped **mapped** the **the** country

country as **as** he **he** went **went** , **,** and **and** his

his maps **maps** remained **remained** in **in** use

use for **for** more **more** than 100 **than** years

years . . he **he** travelled **travelled** all **all** the

the way **way** to **to** what **what** is **is** now

now western **western** Victoria **Victoria** , **,** and

and to to his his surprise surprise and

and annoyance annoyance found found that

that he he was was not not the the first

first white white person person there there .

. the the Henty Henty brothers brothers had

had come come from from Tasmania

Tasmania , , had had built built themselves

themselves a a house house , , had had a

a successful successful farm farm and and fed

fed the the major major and and his his men

men on on roast roast lamb lamb and

and wine wine . self self government

government the the gold gold rushes rushes of

of new new south south Wales Wales and

and Victoria Victoria started started in 1851

in leading leading to to large large numbers

numbers of of people people arriving

arriving to to search search for for gold gold .

. the the population population grew

grew across across south south east

east Australia Australia and and made

made great great wealth wealth and

and industry industry . by 1853 by the

the gold gold rushes rushes had had made

made some some poor poor people people very

very rich rich . the the transportation

transportation of of convicts convicts to

to Australia Australia ended ended in in the

1840s the and 1850s and and and more

more changes changes came came . the

the people **people** in **in** Australia

Australia wanted **wanted** to **to** run **run** their

their own **own** country **country** , **,** and

and not **not** be **be** told **told** what **what** to

to do **do** from **from** London **London** . **.** the

the first **first** governments **governments** in

in the **the** colonies **colonies** were **were** run

run by **by** governors **governors** chosen

chosen by **by** London **London** . **.** soon

soon the **the** settlers **settlers** wanted

wanted local local government government and

and more more democracy democracy .

. William William Wentworth

Wentworth started started the the Australian

Australian Patriotic Patriotic Association

Association Australia's Australia's first

first political political party party in 1835

in to to demand demand democratic

democratic government government . in 1840

in , , the the city city councils councils started

started and and some some people

people could could vote vote . new

new south south Wales Wales Legislative

Legislative Council Council had had its its first

first elections elections in 1843 in , , again

again with with some some limits limits on

on who who could could vote vote . in 1855

in , , limited limited self self government

government was was given given by

by London London to to new new south

south Wales **Wales** , , **Victoria** **Victoria** ,

, **south** **south** Australia **Australia** and

and Tasmania **Tasmania** . **in** 1855 **in** , , the

the right **right** to **to** vote **vote** was **was** given

given to **to** all **all** men **men** over 21 **over** in

in **south** **south** Australia **Australia** . **the**

the other **other** colonies **colonies** soon

soon followed **followed** . **women** **women** were

were given **given** the **the** vote **vote** in **in** the

the parliament **parliament** of **of** **south**

south Australia **Australia** in 1895 **in** and

and they **they** became **became** the **the** first

first women **women** in **in** the **the** world

world allowed **allowed** to **to** stand **stand** in

in elections **elections** . **.** Australians

Australians had **had** started

started **parliamentary** **parliamentary** democracies

democracies **all** **all** across **across** the

the continent **continent** . **.** but **but** voices

voices were **were** getting **getting** louder

louder for **for** all **all** of **of** them **them** to

to come **come** together **together** as **as** one

one country **country** with **with** a **a** national

national parliament **parliament** . **.** the

the Commonwealth **Commonwealth** of

of Australia **Australia** until 1901 **until** ,

, Australia **Australia** was **was** not **not** a

a nation **nation** , **,** it **it** was **was** six

six separate **separate** colonies **colonies** governed

governed by **by** Britain **Britain** . **.** they

they voted voted to to join join to to form

form one one new new country country ,

, called called the the Commonwealth

Commonwealth of of Australia Australia , , in

1901 in . . Australia Australia was was still

still part part of of the the British

British Empire Empire , , and and at at first

first wanted wanted only only British

British or or Europeans Europeans to to come

come to to Australia Australia . . but but soon

soon it it had had its its own own money

money , , its its own own Army Army and

and its its own own Navy Navy . . in

in Australia Australia at at this this time

time , , the the trade trade unions

unions were were very very strong strong ,

, and and they they started started a a political

political party party , , the the Australian

Australian Labor Labor party party . . Australia

Australia passed passed many many laws

laws to to help help the the workers workers .

. in 1914 in , , the the first first world

world war war started started in in Europe

Europe . . Australia Australia joined joined in

in on on the the side side of of Britain

Britain against against Germany Germany ,

, Austria Austria Hungary Hungary and

and the the Ottoman Ottoman Empire Empire .

. Australian Australian soldiers soldiers were

were sent sent to to Gallipoli Gallipoli , , in

in the **the** Ottoman **Ottoman** Empire **Empire** .

. they **they** fought **fought** bravely **bravely** ,

, but **but** were **were** beaten **beaten** by **by** the

the Turks **Turks** . **.** today **today** Australia

Australia remembers **remembers** this **this** battle

battle every **every** year **year** on **on** ANZAC

ANZAC Day **Day** . **.** they **they** also **also** fought

fought on **on** the **the** western **western** front

front . **.** more **more** than 60 **than** , 000

, Australians **Australians** and **and** new

new Zealanders Zealanders were were killed
killed . in 1932 in , the the Sydney
Sydney harbour harbour bridge bridge was
was opened opened . Australia Australia had
had a a really really hard hard time time in
in the the great great Depression Depression of
of the 1930s the and and joined joined Britain
Britain in in a a war war against against Nazi
Nazi Germany Germany when when Hitler
Hitler invaded invaded Poland Poland in 1939

in . but but in 1941 in lots lots of
of Australian Australian soldiers soldiers were
were captured captured in in the the Fall
Fall of of Singapore Singapore by by Japan
Japan . then then Japan Japan started
started attacking attacking Australia
Australia and and people people worried
worried about about invasion invasion . but
but with with help help from from the
the United United states states Navy Navy ,

, the the Japanese Japanese were were stopped
stopped . after after the the war war ,
, Australia Australia became became a a close
close friend friend of of the the United
United states states and and Japan Japan .
. when when the the war war ended ended ,
, Australia Australia felt felt that that it
it needed needed many many more
more people people to to fill fill the
the country country up up and and to to work

work . so the the government

government said said it it would would take

take in in people people from from Europe

Europe who who had had lost lost their

their homes homes in in the the war war .

. it it did did things things like like building

building the the Snowy Snowy mountains

mountains Scheme Scheme . over over the

the next 25 next years years , , millions

millions of of people people came came to

to Australia Australia . they they came

came especially especially from from Italy

Italy and and Greece Greece , , other

other countries countries in in Europe

Europe . later later they they also also came

came from from countries countries like

like Turkey Turkey and and Lebanon

Lebanon . an an important important new

new party party , , the the Liberal

Liberal party party of of Australia

Australia was was made made by by Robert

Robert Menzies Menzies in 1944 in and and it

it won won lots lots of of elections

elections from 1949 from until until in 1972

in , , then then Gough Gough Whitlam

Whitlam won won for for the the Labor

Labor party party . . Whitlam Whitlam made

made changes changes , , but but he he made

made the the Senate Senate unhappy

unhappy and and the the governor

governor General **General** sacked **sacked** him

him and **and** forced **forced** an **an** election

election in 1975 **in** . **.** then **then** Malcolm

Malcolm Fraser **Fraser** won **won** a **a** few

few elections **elections** for **for** the **the** Liberal

Liberal party **party** . **.** in **in** the 1960s

the many **many** people **people** began

began coming **coming** to **to** Australia

Australia from **from** China **China** , **,** Vietnam

Vietnam , **,** Malaysia **Malaysia** and **and** other

other countries **countries** in **in** Asia **Asia** .

. Australia **Australia** became **became** more

more multicultural **multicultural** . **.** in **in** the

1950s **the** and 1960s **and** Australia

Australia became **became** one **one** of **of** the

the richest **richest** countries **countries** in **in** the

the world **world** , **,** helped **helped** by

by mining **mining** and **and** wool **wool** .

. Australia **Australia** started **started** trading

trading more **more** with **with** America

America , , than than Japan Japan . . Australia

Australia supported supported the the United

United states states in in wars wars against

against dictatorships dictatorships in in Korea

Korea and and Vietnam Vietnam and and later

later Iraq Iraq . . Australian Australian soldiers

soldiers also also helped helped the the United

United Nations Nations in in countries

countries like like east east Timor Timor in

1999 in . . in 1973 in , , the the famous

famous Sydney **Sydney** opera **opera** house

house opened **opened** . **.** **in** **in** the 1970s **the** ,

80s **,** and 90s **and** lots **lots** of **of** Australian

Australian movies **movies** , **,** actors **actors** and

and singers **singers** became **became** famous

famous around **around** the **the** world **world** .

. **in** **in** the **the** year 2000 **year** , **,** Sydney

Sydney had **had** the **the** summer

summer Olympics **Olympics** . **.** **in** **in** the 1980s

the and 90s **and** , **,** the **the** Labor **Labor** party

party under under Bob Bob Hawke Hawke and
and Paul Paul Keating Keating , then
then the the Liberal Liberal party party under
under John John Howard Howard made
made lots lots of of changes changes to to the
the economy economy . . Australia
Australia had had a a bad bad recession
recession in 1991 in , , but but when
when other other western western countries
countries had had trouble trouble with

with their their economies economies in 2008
in , , Australia Australia stayed stayed strong
strong . . today today Australia Australia is
is a a rich rich , , peaceful peaceful and
and democratic democratic country country .
. but but it it still still has has problems
problems . . around 4 5 around of
of Australians Australians could could not
not get get a a job job in 2010 in . . a a lot
lot of of land land in in Australia

Australia like like Uluru Uluru has has been

been returned returned to to Aboriginal

Aboriginal people people , , but but lots

lots of of Aboriginals Aboriginals are are still

still poorer poorer than than everybody

everybody else else . . every every year

year the the government government chooses

chooses a a big big number number of of new

new people people from from all all around

around the the world world to to come

come as as immigrants immigrants to to live

live in in Australia Australia . . these

these people people may may come

come because because they they want want to

to do do business business , , or or to to live

live in in a a democracy democracy , , to

to join join their their family family , , or

or because because they they are are refugees

refugees . . Australia Australia took 6 took .

5 . million million immigrants immigrants in

in the 60 the years years after after world

world war war two two , , including

including around 660 around , 000 , refugees

refugees . . Julia Julia Gillard Gillard became

became the the first first woman woman Prime

Prime Minister Minister of of Australia

Australia in 2010 in when when she

she replaced replaced her her Labor

Labor party party colleague colleague Kevin

Kevin Rudd Rudd who who later later replaced

replaced her her . politics politics Australia

Australia is is part part of of the

the Commonwealth Commonwealth of

of Nations Nations . . Australia Australia is

is made made up up of of six six states

states , , and and two two mainland

mainland territories territories . . each

each state state and and territory territory has

has its its own own parliament parliament and

and makes makes its its own own local

local laws laws . the the parliament

parliament of of Australia Australia sits sits in

in Canberra Canberra and and makes

makes laws laws for for the the whole

whole country country , , also also known

known as as the the Commonwealth

Commonwealth or or federation federation .

. the the Federal Federal government

government is is led led by by the the Prime

Prime Minister Minister of of Australia

Australia , who who is is the the member
member of of parliament parliament chosen
chosen as as leader leader . . the the current
current Prime Prime Minister Minister is
is Anthony Anthony Albanese Albanese . . the
the leader leader of of Australia Australia is
is the the Prime Prime Minister Minister ,
, although although the the governor
governor General General represents
represents the the King King of of Australia

Australia , , who who is is also also the
the King King of of the the United
United Kingdom Kingdom of of great
great Britain Britain and and Northern
Northern Ireland Ireland , , as as head head of
of state state . . the the governor
governor General General , , currently
currently his his Excellency Excellency Sam
Sam Mostyn Mostyn , , is is chosen chosen by
by the the Prime Prime Minister Minister .

. Australia **Australia** constitutionally

constitutionally is **is** a **a** constitutional

constitutional monarchy **monarchy** meaning

meaning that **that** the **the** Monarch

Monarch has **has** little **little** power **power** and

and in **in** Australia **Australia** must **must** be

be neutral **neutral** in **in** Australian

Australian politics **politics** culture

culture Australia **Australia** was **was** colonised

colonised by **by** people **people** from **from** the

the United United Kingdom Kingdom of
of great great Britain Britain and and Ireland
Ireland who who also also brought
brought blackbirded blackbirded people
people from from mostly mostly Melanesia
Melanesia , , but but today today people
people from from all all over over the
the world world live live there there .
. English English is is the the main
main spoken spoken language language .

. Christianity **Christianity** is **is** the **the** main
main religion **religion** , **,** though **though** all
all religions **religions** are **are** accepted
accepted and **and** not **not** everybody
everybody has **has** a **a** religion **religion** .

. Australia **Australia** is **is** multicultural
multicultural : **:** all **all** its **its** people
people are **are** encouraged **encouraged** to
to keep **keep** their **their** different
different languages **languages** , **,** religions

religions and and ways ways of of life life ,

, while while also also learning

learning English English and and joining

joining in in with with other other Australians

Australians . . Australia Australia has

has many many immigrants immigrants from

from different different countries

countries around around the the world world .

. famous famous Australian Australian writers

writers include include the the bush

bush balladeers balladeers Banjo Banjo Paterson
Paterson and and Henry Henry Lawson
Lawson who who wrote wrote about about life
life in in the the Australian Australian bush
bush . more more modern modern famous
famous writers writers include include Peter
Peter Carey Carey , , Thomas Thomas Keneally
Keneally and and Colleen Colleen McCullough
McCullough . in 1973 in , , Patrick
Patrick white white won won the the Nobel

Nobel Prize **Prize** in **in** Literature **Literature** ,

, the **the** only **only** Australian **Australian** to

to have **have** achieved **achieved** this **this** ; **;** he

he is **is** seen **seen** as **as** one **one** of **of** the

the great **great** English **English** language

language writers **writers** of **of** the

the twentieth **twentieth** century **century** .

. Australian **Australian** music **music** has

has had **had** world **world** wide **wide** stars

stars , **,** for **for** example **example** the **the** opera

opera singers **singers** Nellie **Nellie** Melba

Melba and **and** Joan **Joan** Sutherland

Sutherland , **,** the **the** rock **rock** and **and** roll

roll bands **bands** Bee **Bee** Gees **Gees** , **,** AC

AC DC **DC** and **and** INXS **INXS** , **,** the

the folk **folk** rocker **rocker** Paul **Paul** Kelly

Kelly musician **musician** , **,** the **the** pop

pop singer **singer** Kylie **Kylie** Minogue

Minogue and **and** Australian **Australian** country

country music **music** stars **stars** Slim

Slim Dusty **Dusty** and **and** John

John Williamson **Williamson** . **.** Australian

Australian Aboriginal **Aboriginal** music

music is **is** very **very** special **special** and

and very **very** ancient **ancient** : **:** it **it** has

has the **the** famous **famous** didgeridoo

didgeridoo woodwind **woodwind** instrument

instrument . **.** Australian **Australian** TV

TV has **has** produced **produced** many

many successful **successful** programs

programs for **for** home **home** and **and** overseas

overseas . **.** Skippy **Skippy** the **the** bush

bush kangaroo **kangaroo** , **,** home **home** and

and away **away** and **and** Neighbours

Neighbours are **are** examples **examples** . **.** it

it has **has** had **had** well **well** known

known TV **TV** stars **stars** , **,** such **such** as

as Barry **Barry** Humphries **Humphries** Dame

Dame Edna **Edna** Everage **Everage** , **,** Steve

Steve Irwin **Irwin** the **the** Crocodile

Crocodile hunter **hunter** and **and** the
the Wiggles **Wiggles** . **.** major **major** Australian
Australian subgroups **subgroups** such **such** as
as the **the** Bogan **Bogan** have **have** been
been shown **shown** on **on** Australian
Australian TV **TV** in **in** shows **shows** such
such as **as** Bogan **Bogan** Hunters **Hunters** and
and Kath **Kath** Kim **Kim** . **.** Australia
Australia has **has** two **two** public
public broadcasters **broadcasters** the **the** ABC

ABC and **and** the **the** multicultural

multicultural SBS **SBS** , **, three**

three commercial **commercial** television

television networks **networks** , **, three**

three pay **pay** TV **TV** services **services** , **, and**

and numerous **numerous** public **public** , **, non**

non profit **profit** television **television** and

and radio **radio** stations **stations** . **. each**

each major **major** city **city** has **has** its **its** daily

daily newspapers **newspapers** , **, and** **and** there

there are **are** two **two** national **national** daily

daily newspapers **newspapers** , **,** the

the Australian **Australian** and **and** the

the Australian **Australian** Financial

Financial Review **Review** . **.** Australian

Australian movies **movies** have **have** a **a** long

long history **history** . **.** the **the** world's

world's first **first** feature **feature** movie

movie was **was** the **the** Australian

Australian movie **movie** the **the** Story **Story** of

of the the Kelly Kelly Gang Gang of 1906 of .

. in 1933 in , , in in the the Wake Wake of

of the the Bounty Bounty , , directed

directed by by Charles Charles Chauvel

Chauvel , , had had Errol Errol Flynn

Flynn as as the the main main actor actor .

. Flynn Flynn went went on on to to a

a celebrated celebrated career career in

in Hollywood Hollywood . . the the first

first Australian Australian Oscar Oscar was

was won won by by the 1942 the Kokoda

Kokoda front front Line Line ! ! , , directed

directed by by Ken Ken G G . . Hall Hall .

. in in the 1970s the and 1980s and Australian

Australian movies movies and and movie

movie stars stars became became world

world famous famous . . there there were

were movies movies like like Picnic Picnic at

at Hanging Hanging rock rock , , Gallipoli

Gallipoli with with Mel Mel Gibson Gibson ,

, the **the** man **man** from **from** Snowy

Snowy River **River** and **and** Crocodile

Crocodile Dundee **Dundee** . **.** Russell

Russell Crowe **Crowe** , **,** Cate **Cate** Blanchett

Blanchett and **and** Heath **Heath** Ledger

Ledger became **became** global **global** stars

stars during **during** the 1990s **the** and

and **Australia** **Australia** starring **starring** Nicole

Nicole Kidman **Kidman** and **and** Hugh

Hugh Jackman **Jackman** made **made** a **a** lot

lot of of money money in 2008 in . Australia

Australia is is a a popular popular destination

destination for for business

business conferences conferences and

and research research , , with with Sydney

Sydney one one of of the the top 20

top meeting meeting destinations

destinations in in the the world world .

. sport sport sport is is an an important

important part part of of Australian

Australian culture culture because because the
the climate climate is is good good for
for outdoor outdoor activities activities . 23 .
5 . Australians Australians over over the
the age age of 15 of regularly regularly take
take part part in in organised
organised sporting sporting activities
activities . the the most most popular
popular sports sports are are Australian
Australian rules rules football football ,

, rugby rugby league league and and cricket

cricket . in in international

international sports sports , , Australia

Australia has has very very strong

strong teams teams in in cricket cricket ,

, hockey hockey , , netball netball , , rugby

rugby league league and and rugby

rugby union union , , and and performs

performs well well in in cycling cycling ,

, rowing rowing and and swimming

swimming . local local popular

popular sports sports include include Australian

Australian rules rules football football , , horse

horse racing racing , , soccer soccer and

and motor motor racing racing . . Australia

Australia has has participated participated in

in every every summer summer Olympic

Olympic Games Games since 1896 since ,

, and and every every Commonwealth

Commonwealth Games Games . . Australia

Australia has **has** hosted **hosted** the 1956
the and 2000 **and** summer **summer** Olympics

Olympics , **,** and **and** has **has** ranked

ranked in **in** the **the** top **top** five **five** medal

medal winners **winners** since 2000 **since** .

. Australia **Australia** has **has** also **also** hosted

hosted the 1938 **the** , 1962 **,** , 1982 **,** and 2006

and Commonwealth **Commonwealth** Games

Games and **and** are **are** to **to** host **host** the

2018 **the** Commonwealth

Commonwealth Games Games . other

other major major international

international events events held held regularly

regularly in in Australia Australia include

include the the Australian Australian open

open , , one one of of the the four four grand

grand Slam Slam tennis tennis tournaments

tournaments , , annual annual international

international cricket cricket matches

matches and and the the Formula Formula one

one Australian **Australian** grand **grand** Prix

Prix . **Corporate** **Corporate** and

and government **government** sponsorship

sponsorship of **of** many **many** sports

sports and **and** elite **elite** athletes **athletes** is

is common **common** in **in** Australia **Australia** .

Televised **Televised** sport **sport** is **is** popular

popular ; **;** some **some** of **of** the **the** highest

highest rated **rated** television

television programs **programs** include

include the the summer summer Olympic

Olympic Games Games and and the the grand

grand finals finals of of local local and

and international international football

football competitions competitions . the

the main main sporting sporting leagues

leagues for for men men are are the the AFL

AFL Australian Australian rules rules football

football , the the NRL NRL rugby

rugby league league , the the a a league

league soccer soccer and and the the NBL

NBL basketball basketball . for for women

women , , they they are are the the AFLW

AFLW Australian Australian rules rules football

football , , ANZ ANZ netball

netball Championships Championships netball

netball , , the the W W league league soccer

soccer and and WNBL WNBL basketball

basketball . famous famous Australian

Australian sports sports players players include

include the the cricketer cricketer Sir
Sir Donald Donald Bradman Bradman , the
the swimmer swimmer Ian Ian Thorpe
Thorpe , the the cricketer cricketer Shane
Shane Warne Warne and and the the athlete
athlete Cathy Cathy Freeman Freeman . art
art festivals festivals just 60 just years
years ago ago , Australia Australia had
had only only one one big big art art festival
festival . now now Australia Australia has

has hundreds hundreds of of smaller
smaller community community based
based festivals festivals , , and and national
national and and regional regional festivals
festivals that that focus focus on on specific
specific art art forms forms . . Indigenous
Indigenous life life Australia Australia is
is home home to to many many animals
animals and and plants plants that that can
can be be found found nowhere nowhere else

else on on Earth Earth , , except
except perhaps perhaps new new Guinea
Guinea . the the platypus platypus and
and the the short short beaked beaked echidna
echidna are are unique unique , , and and are
are two two of of the the only only five
five surviving surviving monotremes
monotremes . monotremes monotremes are
are only only found found in in Australia
Australia and and new new Guinea Guinea .

• Koalas Koalas , kangaroos kangaroos ,
, wallabies wallabies , wombats wombats ,
, numbats numbats and and many many others
others are are marsupials marsupials . • most
most of of the the marsupials marsupials in
in the the world world are are found
found only only on on the the continent
continent or or on on the the neighbouring
neighbouring island island of of new
new Guinea Guinea . • Wildfires Wildfires from

from global global warming warming in 2020

in have have reduced reduced their

their population population . trees trees the

the gum gum trees trees are are almost

almost as as remarkable remarkable as as the

the animals animals . they they are

are mainly mainly Eucalypts Eucalypts and

and other other gum gum trees trees . these

these are are woody woody evergreens

evergreens which which make make essential

essential oils oils and and are are prone

prone to to fire fire . Sticky Sticky heavily

heavily scented scented gum gum squeezes

squeezes out out of of their their wood

wood . the the tribe tribe has has about 860

about species species . they they are are all

all native native to to Southeast Southeast Asia

Asia and and Oceania Oceania . most

most live live in in Australia Australia . until

until British British settlement settlement in

in Australia **Australia** , **these** **these** trees

trees were **were** almost **almost** entirely

entirely unknown **unknown** . **they** **they** had

had been **been** separated **separated** from

from the **the** Americas **Americas** , **Africa**

Africa and **and** much **much** of **of** Asia

Asia for **for** millions **millions** of **of** years

years .